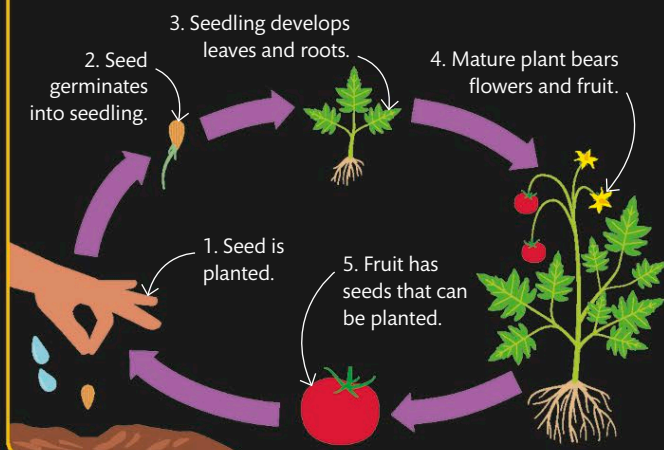


PLANT LIFE CYCLES

The life cycle of a plant such as a tomato plant begins when its seed is planted. The seed germinates into a seedling, which grows into a plant.

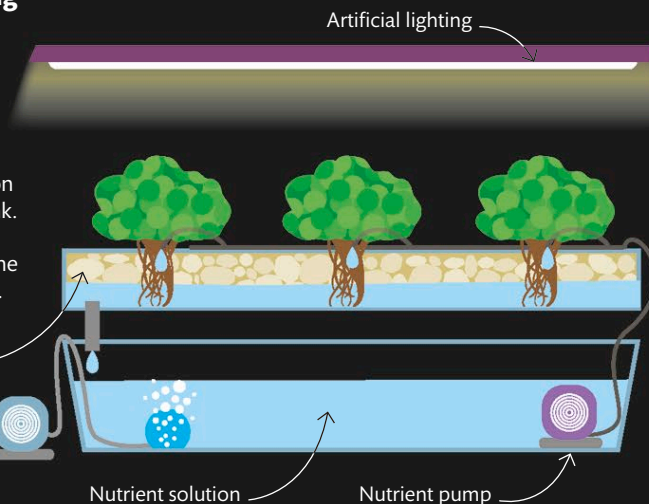


Hydroponic farming

In hydroponic farms, seeds are not planted in soil, but instead placed in a different substance, commonly a sponglike material. This is kept moist by a nutrient solution pumped from another tank. Artificial lamps mimic the effect of sunlight to help the plants grow and bear fruit.

Sponglike material

Air pump ensures oxygen is present in the solution.



Lots of lettuce

At a hydroponic farm in Rikuzentakata, Japan, lettuce are planted in a circular bed. The bed rotates slowly and the seedlings move in a spiral toward the edge, growing over a period of 30 days. By the time they reach the edge, they are ready to be harvested.